Simmons, Baumann victims—

Sore arm threat gives pitchers nightmares

BY ED WILKS, The Associated Press

It's not the Sniders and Campanellas and Musials or the Williams' and Dobys that give a pitcher nightmares in the Spring. That will come later. Right now, it's the threat of a sore arm that makes 'em toss and turn at night, whether they're veterans like Curt Simmons or bonus kids like Frank Baumann.

The Spring exhibitions have been no picnic for Simmons of the Philadelphia Phillies, who at 26 may be at the end of the line because of persistent arm trouble. Nor have they been reason for optimism for Baumann, who returned to the Red Sox from service with a painful throwing motion.

Simmons, of the Whiz Kids who brought the Phils the National flag in 1950, hasn't been the same since returning from the service in 1952. First he hurt his foot with a power mower. And last Spring his arm went sore.

SIMMONS

The young lefty was only 8-8 last season. This year may be decisive.

"He's felt pretty good this Spring, but he got that old feeling again yesterday, losing his control against the St. Louis Cardinals. He pitched three hitless innings, then was tagged for a run in the fourth and three in the fifth as the Cards won 8-6.

Baumann, who collected a reported $125,000 from the Red Sox before going into the service, didn't have even one good inning against the Pittsburgh Pirates yesterday. Control was his trouble, too, walking four and giving three hits as the Bucs belted him for six runs in the sixth. They got two more off the lefty in the seventh, with Gene Freese smacking a leadoff homer.

Elsewhere, Baltimore tied the score with two ninth-inning runs on Owen Friends' error, then scored four in the 11th on three walks, two singles and Bob Boyd's double to beat the Chicago Cubs 9-5.

BAUER

Brooklyn's World Champion Dodgers evened their Spring set at 2-all with the New York Yankees by beating their World Series victims 5-4 in 10 innings. Hank Bauer homered twice for the Yanks and Gil Hodges and Jackie Robinson blasted one each for the Brooks. But it was Joe Collins' muff of Randy Jackson's double that sent the winning run home.

Milwaukee scored once in the first, then rolled home on a 390-foot grand slam homer by Johnny Logan in the second off Joe Nuxhall to beat the Cincinnati Redlegs 5-3. Nuxhall, who topped the NL with five shutouts in his 17 victories last season, was making his first start with the regulars.

THE REDLEGS' big gun, Ted Kluszewski, played with the "B" team while nursing his pulled hip muscle and swatted a home run and single in an 8-7 defeat by Charleston of the American Assn.

CECCARELLI

Rookie Earl Averill and Chico Carrasquel, late of the White Sox, homered as Cleveland defeated the New York Giants for the sixth time in nine tries 10-5. Willie Mays hit one for the Giants, the only earned run among the three they got in the first four frames against Bob Feller.

Southpaw Art Ceccarelli allowed only two hits, walked one and fanned four in his seven innings as the Kansas City Athletics shut out Detroit's Tigers 2-0. Virgil Trucks, who started for the Tigers and had a three-hit shutout going, twisted his knee in the fifth and had to retire.

The Chicago White Sox teed off on Washington and Ted Abernathy for nine runs in four innings and a 12-2 decision. Cal Abrams hit a three-run homer and a single for the Sox, who had five doubles and the home run in their 10 hits off Abernathy. The Senators contributed five errors.

Exhibition baseball

TODAY'S SCHEDULE

At St. Petersburg, Fla., Philadelphia (N) vs. New York (A).

YESTERDAY'S RESULTS

Chicago (A) 12, Washington (A) 2.
Kansas City (A) 2, Detroit (A) 0.
Baltimore (A) 9, Chicago (N) 5 (11 innings).
Cleveland (A) 10, New York (N) 5.
St. Louis (N) 8, Philadelphia (N) 6.
Pittsburgh (N) 11, Boston (A) 10.
Brooklyn (N) 5, New York (A) 4 (10 innings).
Milwaukee (N) 5, Cincinnati (N) 3.
Charleston (AA) 8, Cincinnati (N) "B" 7.

SATURDAY'S SCHEDULE

At Lakeland, Fla., Boston (A) vs. Detroit (A).
At Phoenix, Ariz., Baltimore (A) vs. New York (N).
At Clearwater, Fla., Chicago (A) vs. Philadelphia (N).
At Tucson, Ariz., Chicago (N) vs. Cleveland (A).
At St. Petersburg, Fla., New York (A) vs. St. Louis (N).
At New Orleans, La., Kansas City (A) vs. Pittsburgh (N).
At Tampa, Fla., Brooklyn (N) vs. Cincinnati (N).
At Atlanta, Ga., Milwaukee (N) vs. Atlanta (SA).

ANDY COHEN
. . . At Pel helm

Benny Marshall says—

Bobby Bragan brings good McMahan news

Gene Hassell, who was his roommate (and never the silent partner type) had the word on Jack McMahan one night last Summer after the lean lefthander had blown out an enemy fire and brought in a Baron win which almost got away.

"I know what does it for him," Hassel was yelling through the steam of the showers to the dressing room at large.

"That guy just KNOWS he can get a hitter out.

"I don't care if it was Stan Musial up there, and you had the bases loaded and you hollered for old Mack, he'd come walking in thinking all the way he was going to do what you needed him to.

"And doggonit, I believe he would!"

For a Missouri boy born and bred and steeped in the tradition of all St. Louis Cardinal fans that Mr. Musial is absolutely the greatest who ever swung a bat, this bordered on heresy . . . But Hassell meant it, and he had teammates who'd agree.

It looks like they'll be getting a chance to check their judgment, too.

JACK McMAHAN
. . . New fires

The eventuality conjured up by little Hassell in the exuberance after one Southern League victory in 1955, might even be coming about before the 1956 season of baseball is done.

McMahan, the End Man, Baron reliefer deluxe, is beginning to look like a sure thing on the Pittsburgh Pirate pitching staff which will work for Birmingham's Bobby Bragan this year.

In the league where Bragan manages and McMahan will pitch, Stan The Man hits.

I wouldn't go betting too many times against McMahan, either; not after a season of watching him crank up in the bullpen, adjust his wad of eatin' tobacco carefully, wipe his specks with the big red bandanna and get out there and go to work.

LATEST REPORT ON THE Arkansas southpaw who won 11 and lost five and saved countless others for Birmingham last year comes as straight as straight can be . . . from Manager Bragan, himself.

In town on a sad mission, the funeral of his grandmother, the rookie National League skipper had encouraging things to say today about Rookie Pitcher McMahan. Among them:

"He has been very impressive every time we've looked at him.

"We need lefthanders, and he's lefthanded. And the thing you need most in a relief pitcher, he's got. He can get the ball over the plate with something on it.

"He looks at home relieving. He knows what he's doing."

Baron fans who've learned to appreciate the great, great value of the pitching man who can come into the tight spot, and out of it, will be glad to hear the news.

BRAGAN'S PIRATE SQUAD broke camp today at Fort Myers, Fla., headed for an exhibition series at New Orleans, and he plans to join the team there.

His analysis of the outfit which he'll try to bring out of the basement continues just as was when Alf Van Hoose went Florida calling on one of this town's more talented contributions to the majors.

Says he, again: "We've got to rely on our pitching, and the defense. We aren't going to clobber anybody much.

"I'm very well pleased up to now. We've been doing pretty good. And nobody ever enjoyed a finer Spring training. It's a wonderful setup at Fort Myers."

Bragan, moving from Hollywood for his first big league managing job, goes with little trepidation. He knows the score, and his record speaks highly for his ability.

"NO," HE ANSWERS a question, "Big league managing won't be much different from Triple-A. For that matter, it's not any different, anywhere, all the way from top to bottom. A manager has more or less the same things to do any place.

"There will be more attention paid to everything you do, naturally, but that's about the only thing. More people are watching you."

It goes without saying that a lot of those "more people," including a whole passel of relatives, will be watching from right here, Bobby Bragan's old hometown . . . And they'll be keeping a sharp eye, too, on one of the nicer kids who ever got a break toward the bigtime, McMahan of the Barons.

One fleeting question comes to mind as this essay ends . . .

I wonder if there's another McMahan at Ocala with the new Barons? If not, just a halfway reasonable facsimile will do. We've got a new season, too, just like the Pirates.

Top drivers enter April 15

It's beginning to look like the United States Auto Club, successors to the American Automobile Assn., which for years sponsored the famous Indianapolis "500," will bring everything but Indianapolis Speedway to Birmingham Sunday afternoon, April 15.

Duane Carter, president of the new racing organization, notified the Birmingham Racing Club that three more Indianapolis Speedway drivers have entered the first sprint car races to be staged by the local club.

Carter, himself a veteran of Speedway racing, said that in addition to Bob Sweikert, winner of the Indianapolis "500" last year as well as winner of the AAA crown, other famous Indianapolis drivers who will come here will include Pat O'Connor, who finished eighth in the 1955 classic; Eddie Sacks, No. 2 man in the AAA point standings last year; Elmer George, of Los Angeles, who will drive a car owned by Mary Holman, daughter of Tony Holman, owner of Indianapolis Speedway, and Don Branson, of Nashville, one of the top men in AAA standings last season.

SWEIKERT AND some of the other drivers were rained out at Dayton, Ohio, last Sunday, but they will race there April 8, the same day the Birmingham Racing Club resumes its modified and sportsman type racing season at Fairgrounds Speedway.

Thursday's fights

BY THE ASSOCIATED PRESS

PARIS — Germinal Ballarin, 138, France, outpointed Kid Gavilan, 150, Cuba, 10.

TOKYO—Hitoshi Misako, 111¾, Japan, outpointed Danny Kidd, 112, Manila, 12. (For Orient flyweight championship.)

Few holdovers—

Pels wait on Pirates

BY HARRY MARTINEZ
Sports editor, The New Orleans States

NEW ORLEANS, March 30—(AP)—How strong a team the New Orleans Pelicans will put on the field opening night, April 10 at Mobile, depends entirely on what players the Pittsburgh Pirates leave here after their series with Kansas City April 4. Other players must come from the Hollywood club, also affiliated with the Pirates.

There'll be very few holdovers from last season. Only Earl Weaver, second baseman from last year's club is back among the infielders. The Pirates optioned Frank Barone, shortstop to the Pels to replace Gair Allie, who has been sent to Hollywood.

Manager Andy Cohen is awaiting the Pirates' decision on a first baseman and a third baseman. General Manager Vince Rizzo is trying to talk Joe L. Brown and Branch Rickey Jr. into sending Bob Skinner back to play first but Hollywood will have first call on him. Rizzo also would like to get Leo Rodriguez, who was a star at third for the pennant-winning Mexico City club last year.

(Third in a series)

Barone, the new shortstop, played fine ball for Williamsport last season. He stole 26 bases and fielded exceptionally well. He hit .264. The Pirates thought so much of him they took him to their Spring training camp at Fort Myers, Florida.

Ray Swarts, who played centerfield last year, has been returned to the Pelicans. A recent addition is J. C. Powers, who started the '55 season here and was later sent out to Williamsport. Manager Andy Cohen likes Powers for his lefthanded hitting. However, at least one more outfielder is needed and Cohen has hopes of getting Gail Henley.

The Pels have only rookie catchers in their camp at Huntsville, Tex. It looks like the Pirates will keep Danny Kravitz and the Birds might have to go out and buy an experienced catcher from some other club.

IT'S A CASE of waiting on Pittsburgh and Hollywood for the pitchers. Curt Raydon was one Manager Cohen figured on strongly but he is to be given a chance to make the Hollywood club. Don Urquhart, a righthander who looked good last Spring but quit baseball in June and returned home, is back. He has been the most impressive of the Pel pitchers. Lefthander Lenny Yochim is back.

Cohen has been experimenting with a group of young pitchers at Huntsville but would like to get Roger Sawyer back from Hollywood.

David Jacobs, with Burlington last season, may be retained as a utility infielder if the Pels don't get Jim Rice back. He has been most impressive of the new infielders at Huntsville.

THE PIRATES play a four-game series here with Kansas City starting Saturday and what help Andy Cohen hopes to get from Pittsburgh will net be known until the Pittsburgh bigwigs reach a decision here on what players are to be left with the Pelicans.

Harry Fisher, pitcher with the Pels in 1950, was returned. He played semi-pro ball in Canada last year. Cohen hopes to keep him on his staff because he is also a power hitter.

The Atlanta Crackers, with more seasoned players and help from Milwaukee, look like pre-season favorites to win the pennant. Birmingham, Nashville, Mobile, Memphis, New Orleans, Chattanooga, Little Rock are picked in order.

SOLUNAR TABLES by John Alden Knight

(Prepared for The News)

The schedule of Solunar Periods, as printed below, has been taken from John Alden Knight's SOLUNAR TABLES.

Date Mar. Day	A.M. Min.	A.M. Maj.	P.M. Min.	P.M. Maj.
30 Fri.	8:05	1:55	8:35	2:20
31 Sat.	8:55	2:45	9:25	3:10
April				
1 Sun.	9:40	3:30	10:10	3:55

Chisox return DuFour to Chix

MEMPHIS, March 30—(AP)—The Memphis Chicks' pitching staff got another beefing up today with the return of Bill DuFour from the Chicago White Sox.

DuFour, stock righthander, won 11 games and lost nine for the Chicks last year.

Four other pitchers, including Paul Stuffel, were obtained from the White Sox yesterday. Stuffel, also a righthander, had a 12-3 record with the Memphis Southern Association club last year.

Thursday's fights

LOS ANGELES — Jimmy Carter, 138, New York, outpointed Don Jordan, 138, Los Angeles, 10.

SAN FRANCISCO — Dave Johnson, 146, San Francisco, stopped Phil Kim, 146, Honolulu, 6.

PHILADELPHIA — Clifton Bradley, 127, Philadelphia, outpointed Tony Longo, 131½, Baltimore, 8.

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